

# Linchpin

## Objective:

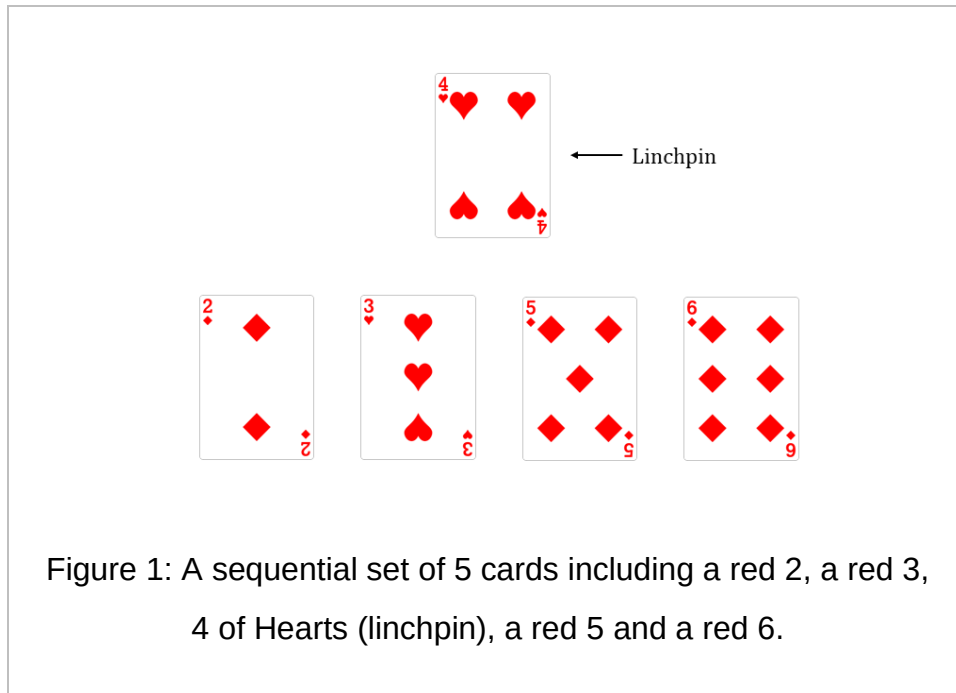
Be the first player to arrange five cards, including your linchpin card, in a sequential order of rank and matching colour.

## You Need:

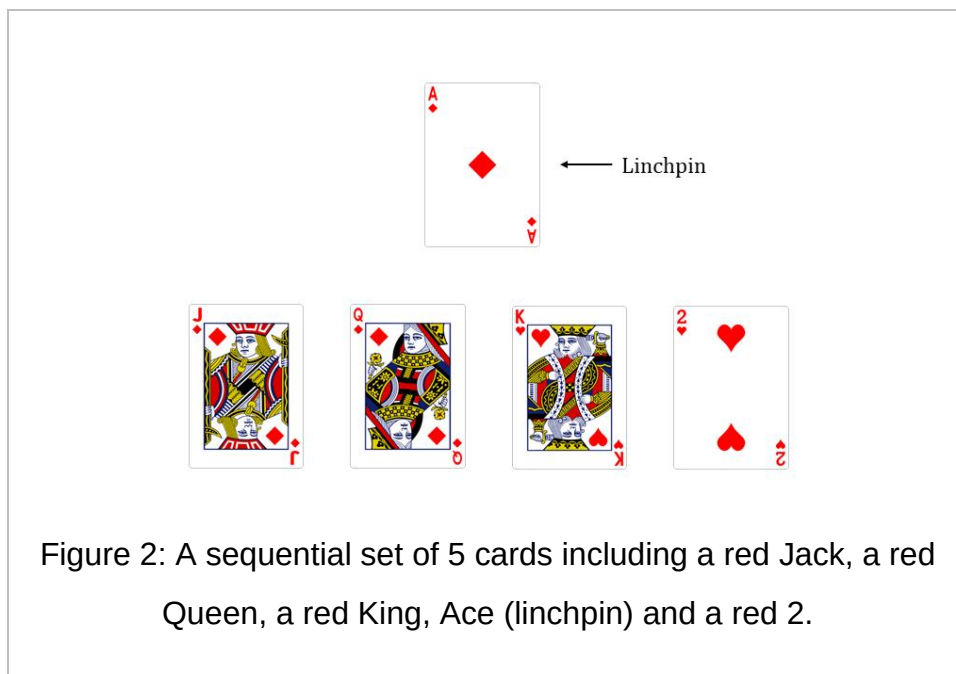
- 3-6 players
- One 52-card deck and four Jokers (use two 52-card decks for more than 4 players)

## Linchpin:

- Each player draws one face-down card, known as the "linchpin." Players can look at their own linchpin anytime but must keep it secret from the other players.
- If you receive a Joker as your linchpin, you must return it and draw a different card.
- The linchpin card determines the number range and the colour of the final set of five sequential cards that players are aiming to collect (only the colour of the linchpin matters, not the suit).
  - This final sequential set of five cards must include the linchpin.
- The linchpin can appear at any point within the sequence of five cards. For example, if your linchpin is a 4 of Hearts, a sequential set could consist of:
  - a red Ace, a red 2, a red 3, 4 of Hearts (linchpin) and a red 5,
  - or 4 of Hearts (linchpin), a red 5, a red 6, a red 7 and a red 8,
  - or a red 2, a red 3, 4 of Hearts (linchpin), a red 5 and a red 6 (see Figure 1 below).
    - The linchpin could appear anywhere within the set.

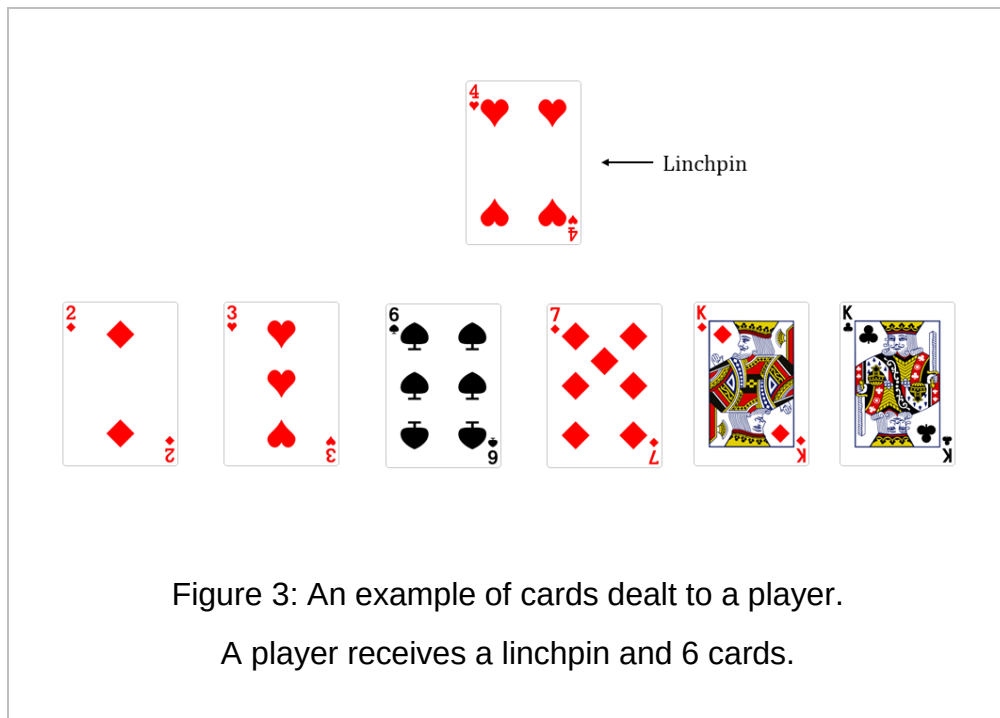


- A sequence can “crossover” from the high-ranked face cards and into the lower range of numbers. For example, a sequential set could include a Jack, Queen, King, Ace (1) and 2 (see Figure 2 below).



**Setup:**

1. **Shuffle:** Thoroughly shuffle a normal 52-card deck (or 2 decks if more than 4 players).
2. **Choose a player to deal.**
3. **Draw the linchpin:** The dealer fans out the cards, face down, and each player chooses a card, keeping its value secret.
4. **Dealing:** Deal 6 cards to each player, one card at a time, starting with the player on your left.
  - If a player receives a five-card sequence (that includes their linchpin) during the deal, all players must return their cards to be reshuffled.



5. **Draw Pile:** Place the remaining cards face down in the centre of the playing area to form the draw pile.

## How to Play:

1. **Turn Order:** Players take turns in a clockwise order, beginning with the player to the dealer's left.
2. **Drawing:** On your turn, draw one card from the top of the draw pile, or from the top of discard pile.
  - If the draw pile runs out, shuffle the discard pile to form a new draw pile, leaving the top card face-up.
3. **Discarding:** Decide whether to keep the drawn card:
  - If you keep the drawn card, remove one card from your hand and discard it face-up next to the draw pile. This will form the discard pile.
  - If you do not wish to keep the drawn card, place it face-up on the discard pile.
4. **Hand Maintenance:** Maintain six cards in hand until you declare a win.

## Special Cards and Their Abilities:

The Jack, Queen, King and Ace cards all have special abilities that come into play when the card is discarded.

### 1. Jack (J) – Swap Cards

- When you have a Jack that you want to discard, you must choose either to:
  - Use it to take the top card off the discard pile, regardless of whose turn it is.
    - This move does not disrupt the normal order of play.

**OR**

- Use it as part of your turn to ask one other player to show you any three of their cards of their choosing.
- You can then swap one of your cards with one of their three and then return their cards.
  - Playing a Jack counts as your turn.

## 2. **Queen (Q) – Skip a Turn or Reverse Direction**

- When you have a Queen that you want to discard, you must choose either to:
  - Discard the Queen and announce that the player after your turn must skip their turn.
- OR**
- Discard the Queen and announce that the direction of play must reverse.
- Playing a Queen counts as your turn.

## 3. **King (K) – Search for a Card**

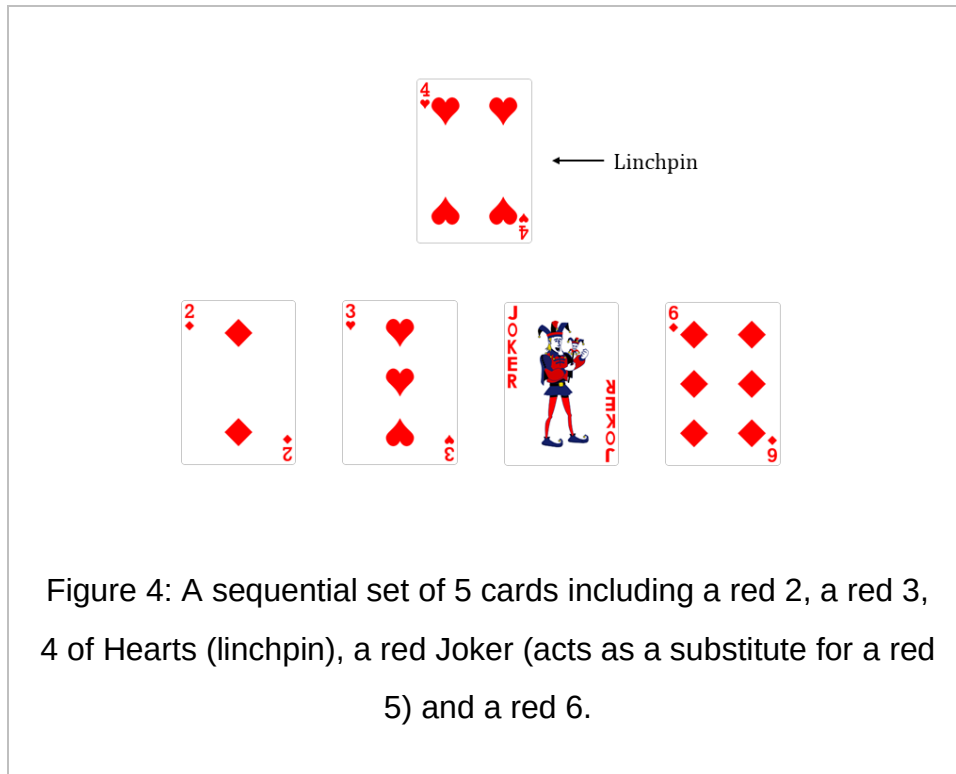
- When you discard a King, you can go through the discard pile and choose a single card you want.
  - Always play the King before you pick up a card.
- Playing a King counts as your turn.

## 4. **Ace (A) – Block Special Cards**

- An Ace can be used to block the special abilities of the Jack and the Queen, when another player is using one of these special cards to target you.
- Announce the block and discard the Ace from your hand. Then pick up another card.
  - You are not allowed to pick up the discarded Ace again as part of your turn.

## 5. **Joker – Substitute Card**

- A Joker can substitute for any card within the final sequence, but it must match the colour of the linchpin (see Figure 4 below).



### Winning:

The first player to complete their set of five cards and announce it within their turn is the winner. Show your hand to everyone to confirm that the cards are in the correct sequential order and colour and include the linchpin.

Play can continue until there are only two players left, at which point the game ends.

When a player wins, their cards must be reshuffled into the draw pile, and play continues.